

Field Notes on Small-Team Software Development

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To clarify: small teams can't tackle projects involving extreme regulatory requirements, large-scale data migrations needing continuous operation, or ultra-sensitive real-time systems without outside support. They also struggle with coordinating efforts across multiple teams when those teams have interdependent work. Each triumph of a small team fundamentally aligns with their constraints -- picking problems that suit the framework they've built around themselves. The greatest challenge remains whether this method of doing things will continue to be valued as the team expands and matures.